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Attributes of Love

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Attributes of Love

"God is love."

— 1 John 4:8

The Holy One is not only pure. He gives Himself.

This chapter is written so that we will not lose that wonder. After self-existence, sovereignty, and holiness, a reader might expect a God who is complete, enthroned, and morally perfect—and therefore remote. Scripture will not leave us there. The same God who *is*, who *reigns*, and who is *holy* has a heart that moves toward the unworthy. Love is not a later addition to who He is. Love is what He is. Before there was a world to save, the Father, the Son, and the Spirit already lived in perfect self-giving communion. Creation and redemption are the overflow of that life, not the repair of a lonely deity.

This category gathers five attributes of that generosity.

- **Love** — His very essence is self-giving, sacrificial love.
- **Merciful** — He withholds the punishment we deserve out of tender compassion.
- **Gracious** — He freely bestows unearned favor upon the undeserving.
- **Good** — He is the source and definition of all goodness, and He delights to bless.
- **Wise** — He orders all things with perfect wisdom for the highest good of those He loves.

These are not five softer feelings set against His other perfections. They are one holy love, seen from five sides. Mercy is love refusing to give us only what we have earned. Grace is love giving us what we could never earn. Goodness is love taking pleasure in the blessing of His creatures. Wisdom is love refusing shortcuts; it chooses the path that leads to what is truly best, even when that path is a cross.

This chapter answers a question the others cannot answer: *How does God give Himself?* A God of mere power could rule us. A God of mere purity could expose us. Love comes for us. It seeks our highest good at His own cost. In a world marked by pain, rejection, and the fear that we are disposable, this is the gospel's open door: the Almighty is not indifferent. He is for us in Christ.

The pages that follow should be read with an open heart, but not a careless one. This love is not sentiment. It is the holy God giving Himself. Receive it. Then learn its shape—mercy toward the guilty, grace toward the empty, goodness toward the weary, and wisdom that trusts His way when yours has failed.

God Is Love

His very nature is self-giving love.

Because God is love, I will love and give as I have been loved by Him.

God Is Merciful

He withholds the judgment we deserve.

Because God is merciful, I will come to Him when I have failed and show mercy to others.

God Is Gracious

He gives unearned favor to the undeserving.

Because God is gracious, I will receive His undeserved gifts and respond with thanksgiving.

God Is Good

He is the source of all goodness and delights to bless.

Because God is good, I will trust His heart when His hand is heavy.

God Is Wise

He orders all things for what is truly best.

Because God is wise, I will obey His will and trust that it is best.

Love does not remain an idea once it has reached us. It becomes a way of life.

The mercy that spared us begins to loosen our grip on other people's debts. The grace that filled our emptiness begins to make us generous. The goodness that met us in weariness begins to make us kind. The wisdom that led us by a better path than our own begins to make us patient with those still finding their way. We do not invent this life. We bear the family likeness of the God who first loved us.

In a world that knows much about hunger and little about being kept, this is no small witness. The love we have received is not ours to store. It is ours to spend—on the guilty, the empty, the tired, and the lost—until the heart of God is seen in the ordinary rooms where we live.

Go Deeper:

- >> [God Is Love](#)
- >> [God Is Merciful](#)
- >> [God Is Gracious](#)
- >> [God Is Good](#)
- >> [God Is Wise](#)

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In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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